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By NND NARA, Date 1994-1996

China
President of

(21)

THE OFEICE OF THE PRESIDENT

REPUBLIC OF CHINA

June 9, 1961

(1)

Dear Mr. Vice-President:

Your kind letter transmitted to me through your Embassy here is very much appreciated. I wish to take the opportunity to extend to you my sincere congratulations on the successful conclusion of your recent mission to Asia. You have left with us in free China lasting impressions of forthrightness and sincerity that provide proof of American leadership and confidence so greatly needed by the free world today.

The assurances you have given your Asian allies on behalf of President Kennedy and the United States Government have gone a long way to allay much of the uncertainty and apprehension widely felt at one time by the free nations of Asia over the United States position vis-a-vis world Communism. I need not say how much we value your public reaffirmation of the United States determination to continue her assistance to free China, her support of the Republic of China's legitimate position in the United Nations and her opposition to recognizing the Chinese Communist regime or its seating in the world organization. What is even more important is that these publicly renewed pledges serve also to reassure other free countries on the periphery of the Communist-controlled China mainland and to give fresh hopes to the enslaved Chinese people behind the Iron Curtain.

It is against this background, Mr. Vice-President, that we are shocked by your Government's recent efforts, through explorations in Moscow, to seek establishment of diplomatic relations with the Communist regime of Outer Mongolia, an outright puppet of the Soviet Union and a co-aggressor in the Korean War. My Government has registered its strongest opposition against this move with your Department of State. I am afraid that advocates of this move do not fully realize the disastrous effect such an action, if carried out, would have on the prestige of the United States herself and on the morale of all free Asian nations, particularly those under constant threat of Communist aggression, such as Korea, Vietnam, Thailand, the Philippines and free China.

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To the peoples of these countries, such a move on the part of the United States could mean only one thing, and that is, that the United

His Excellency
Vice-President Lyndon B. Johnson,
Washington D. C.

(signed)
Chiang Kai-shek

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States, the leader of the free world, is retreating from principles in the global struggle against world Communism. This conclusion is only natural since reasons given for such a move are patently far-fetched. It is hardly conceivable that the United States authorities would risk weakening our common anti-Communist front in Asia by recognition of Outer Mongolia for the nebulous objective of splitting Peiping from Moscow, because this would mean sacrificing an all-important principle and abandoning a tested ally for a highly elusive tactical gain of a dubious nature. Furthermore, another question would immediately rise in the minds of all freedom-loving people. Is it the United States policy now to relax her stand heretofore maintained in not recognizing regimes wantonly created by the Communists since World War II? I would be less than frank, should I fail to point out that diplomatic recognition of Outer Mongolia by the United States could only be interpreted by the rest of the world as opening the flood-gate for recognizing the other Communist puppet regimes in China, Korea, Vietnam and elsewhere. It would also be viewed as paving the way for the so-called "two Chinas" arrangement. Whatever motives the United States Government may ascribe to the recognition of Outer Mongolia could not undo the great harm to the cause of freedom.

In this connection, I hope you would agree, Mr. Vice-President, that, in appraising the proposed United States move in question, it is not relevant whether the Government of the Republic of China had earlier recognized the independence of Outer Mongolia pursuant to the Sino-Soviet Treaty of 1945, a point on which American authorities concerned appear to rely in arguing against my Government's opposition. This argument is particularly surprising because it comes from the United States. In the first place, the entire world knows that my Government was forced to assent to Outer Mongolia's independence as a result of the secret deal at Yalta, a deal in which the Republic of China had no part. In the second place, the Soviet Union at the very outset violated all the provisions of the Sino-Soviet Treaty, including her undertaking to respect Outer Mongolia's independent status. These violations nullified the basis of China's approval of Outer Mongolia's independence. Consequently, my Government, following the United Nations General Assembly resolution of February 1, 1952 attesting to the Soviet violations of the Sino-Soviet Treaty, abrogated this Treaty on February 25, 1953. It has been and still is my Government's position that the puppet regime of Outer Mongolia has never achieved a truly independent status because of Soviet violations of the above-mentioned Treaty.

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Mr. Vice-President, I believe that you would understand why the people and Government of the Republic of China consider the problem of Outer Mongolia as of vital importance to them and to the future of the entire free world. We have requested the Department of State to reconsider its policy and to withhold any further action pending consultation with us. It is my sincere hope that you would deem it fit to draw President Kennedy's personal attention to the serious repercussions which are bound to come if the United States should persist in her decision in this connection.

This coming September we shall be faced with a most difficult situation in the United Nations General Assembly. The United States, in contemplating recognition of Outer Mongolia, is tantamount to serving notice to the rest of the world that she is retreating from her basic position. Not only would doubts be created in the minds of all free Chinese with regard to the United States stand in the struggle against Communism, but fear would be engendered that if the United States could disregard an ally's legitimate rights and interests concerning Outer Mongolia, she would also be capable of deliberately carrying out the so-called "two Chinas" policy.

I must say in no uncertain terms, Mr. Vice-President, that the wishful thinking manifested in the "two Chinas" theory, if permitted to persist, cannot but cast an ominous shadow on the relations between our two countries. If the Chinese people were to accept any "two Chinas" arrangement, they would be selling their national soul and the net result could only be the accelerated communization of entire Asia, and create ever greater difficulties for all peoples who would be free. Such a catastrophe surely could not work to the interest of the United States.

You may recall, Mr. Vice-President, the late General Marshall's efforts to press my Government into accepting a "coalition government" with the Communists after World War II. The Government of the Republic of China was not unaware that to reject the American proposal would render cooperation with the United States difficult and that the withdrawal of American aid and support might even lead to the loss of the Chinese mainland to the Communists. But my Government was left with no choice in the matter but to reject this proposal because acceptance of it would have destroyed the moral foundation and the inherent dignity of the Chinese nation. Had we yielded on that point, the communization of China would have been complete and there would be no free China as there is today.

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The entire situation in Asia and the Pacific today would have been radically different, as the countries now still free would most probably have been enslaved.

Should the United States be misled into considering the "two Chinas" theory as a solution to the China problem, eventually there would be only "one Communist China", not "two Chinas".

My views and observations are based on our bitter experiences in combatting Communists in the past few decades. I regret to say that even today there is a deplorable lack of understanding, among many of the Western statesmen, of the Chinese people's dedication to their struggle against Communism, of the state of mind of the Asians, and of the true character of International Communism. In dealing with problems in East Asia, these people are often inclined to seek only momentary advantages, even at the expense of principles, without stopping to think of the long-term consequences. Needless to say, they play into the Communist hands and reduce the free world to passivity.

I must say, Mr. Vice-President, that the Chinese people greatly resent the United States move in regard to Outer Mongolia because it gives the Communists aid and comfort while hurting a loyal ally. That this move would seriously harm the morale of all free Chinese, civilians as well as those in the armed forces, is no sheer speculation. I earnestly hope that the United States Government would reconsider the matter in the light of Sino-American relations and of the long-range interests of free Asia, so that an irreparable mistake may yet be avoided. In the struggle against world Communism, the survival of all free nations is indivisible. Our two countries have every reason to be mindful of the fact that, as allies who have weathered adversities together, we cannot but share whatever may happen to either of us.

I have expressed my views at some length and in language not ordinarily permitted by diplomatic niceties, only because I share the belief of all your friends that you, Mr. Vice-President, are among the most dedicated on the fore-front of our common battle against Communism. In a sense, this letter is in continuation of our talks during your recent visit here, which, owing to its briefness, did not allow a fuller exchange of views on all questions of mutual concern. I shall indeed be gratified if you would apprise President Kennedy of the contents of this letter.

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With warmest personal regards to you and Mrs. Johnson, in which my wife joins me,

Sincerely yours,

正中蔣

Chiang Kai-shek